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Autorità signorile e fonti del diritto. Le «*Constitutiones appellationum*» di Antonio, Guidantonio e Federico da Montefeltro (Urbino, 1384-1559), Course: Storia del diritto medievale e moderno (prof. Sandro Notari). Università di Urbino, Dipartimento di Giurisprudenza - 16 April 2026, Urbino, Italy.

Translated Title : *The Lord and the Law: The Constitutiones appellationum of Antonio, Guidantonio, and Federico of Montefeltro (Urbino, 1384–1559)*

We tend to think of law as something the state makes — its most visible, and perhaps most important, product. But has this always been the case? And can the opposite hold true? The Italian Renaissance states, and the *signoria* of Urbino in particular, are especially instructive on this point. Drawing on Urbino's statutory legislation — above all the unpublished series of the so-called *Constitutiones appellationum*, issued by Antonio, Guidantonio, and Federico da Montefeltro (1384–1559) — this lecture examines the relationship between state and law as a constitutive feature of European legal history. Against the view that late-medieval *signorie* asserted themselves without, and before, any project for territorial governance — relying, that is, on legislation that was largely piecemeal and occasional — the *Constitutiones* represent instead an example of "government through law." They are, moreover, a precious source in an otherwise patchy landscape of surviving statutory material, and one that opens the way to long-term comparison of how legislative systems evolved within the Urbino state.

PROIEZIONE TERRITORIALE DELLO STATO DI URBINO (XIII-XVI secc.)

